

Tai Motion

TAI CHI · GUIDE SERIES

Sweet & Gentle

25 Lighter Desserts

Easy, wholesome treats that satisfy a sweet tooth the gentle way — more fruit, oats and calcium, less refined sugar.

25 recipes · Lighter on sugar · Simple to make

Welcome to your Desserts guide

A little something sweet is one of life's simple pleasures — and there's no reason to give it up. The trick is choosing treats that love you back.

Every recipe here leans on naturally sweet fruit, wholesome oats, and calcium-rich yogurt and ricotta, with far less refined sugar than a shop-bought dessert. They're quick, forgiving, and made from everyday ingredients.

You'll find 25 recipes across five sections — fruit-forward treats, creamy and chilled, warm and comforting, no-bake bites, and lighter baked classics. Dip in wherever your mood takes you.

A quick note before you begin. These are lighter treats, not medical or dietary advice. If you have diabetes, kidney disease, food allergies, or take medication that interacts with certain foods, please check portions and ingredients with your doctor or dietitian. Sweet treats — even healthy ones — are best enjoyed in sensible portions.

A few gentle notes

Sweetness is adjustable. Start with less honey than a recipe suggests — ripe fruit is often sweet enough on its own.

Make them yours. Swap in the fruit, nuts and milk you prefer, including dairy-free options.

Portion with kindness. A small serving, slowly enjoyed, is deeply satisfying.



Fruit-Forward Treats

Naturally sweet, full of fibre, and about as simple as dessert gets. Let ripe fruit do the work.



SERVES 2 • 30 MIN • FIBRE • NO ADDED SUGAR

Baked Cinnamon Apples

You'll need: 2 apples (cored), 1 tsp cinnamon, a handful of chopped walnuts, a splash of water

1. Heat oven to 180°C / 350°F.
2. Fill the apple centres with walnuts and dust with cinnamon.
3. Add a splash of water and bake 25–30 min until soft.



SERVES 2 • 10 MIN • CALCIUM

Grilled Peaches with Yogurt

You'll need: 2 ripe peaches (halved), 2 tbsp Greek yogurt, a little honey, a pinch of cinnamon

1. Grill or pan-sear the peach halves cut-side down 3–4 min.
2. Top with yogurt, a drizzle of honey and a pinch of cinnamon.



SERVES 2 • 5 MIN • NO ADDED SUGAR

Berry-Banana “Nice” Cream

You'll need: 2 frozen bananas, 1 cup frozen berries, a splash of milk

1. Blend the frozen fruit with a splash of milk until creamy.
2. Eat straight away, like a soft-serve ice cream.



SERVES 2 • 12 MIN • FIBRE

Warm Spiced Pears

You'll need: 2 pears (sliced), ½ tsp cinnamon, a pinch of nutmeg, 1 tsp butter

1. Gently cook the pear slices in butter with the spices.
2. Stir over low heat 8–10 min until tender.



SERVES 2 • 10 MIN • LIGHT • HYDRATING

Melon & Mint Cup

You'll need: 2 cups cubed melon, a few mint leaves, a squeeze of lime

1. Toss the melon with torn mint and a squeeze of lime.
2. Chill 10 minutes and serve.



Creamy & Chilled

Cool, smooth and satisfying — with yogurt, ricotta and even avocado quietly adding calcium and good fats.



SERVES 1 • 5 MIN • CALCIUM • PROTEIN

Greek Yogurt Berry Parfait

You'll need: $\frac{3}{4}$ cup Greek yogurt, $\frac{1}{2}$ cup berries, 2 tbsp granola

1. Layer yogurt, berries and granola in a glass.
2. Repeat the layers and serve.



SERVES 2 • OVERNIGHT • FIBRE • OMEGA-3

Vanilla Chia Pudding

You'll need: 3 tbsp chia seeds, 1 cup milk, $\frac{1}{2}$ tsp vanilla, berries to top

1. Stir the chia into the milk with the vanilla.
2. Rest 5 min, stir again, chill overnight.
3. Top with berries.



SERVES 2 • 25 MIN • HEALTHY FATS

Banana-Cocoa Mousse

You'll need: 1 ripe avocado, 1 banana, 2 tbsp cocoa, a drizzle of honey

1. Blend everything until silky smooth.
2. Chill 20 min — rich chocolate, no cream.



SERVES 2 • 5 MIN • CALCIUM • PROTEIN

Whipped Ricotta with Berries

You'll need: ½ cup ricotta, ½ tsp vanilla, 1 tsp honey, berries

1. Whip the ricotta with vanilla and honey until fluffy.
2. Spoon over a bowl of fresh berries.



SERVES 4 • 3 HR • CALCIUM

Frozen Yogurt Bark

You'll need: 1 cup Greek yogurt, a drizzle of honey, berries, chopped nuts

1. Spread the yogurt on a lined tray.
2. Scatter berries and nuts, freeze 3 hr, break into pieces.



Warm & Comforting

For cooler evenings — gently spiced, softly sweet, and kind to digestion.
Comfort in a bowl.



MAKES 6 • 25 MIN • FIBRE

Baked Oatmeal Cups

You'll need: 2 cups oats, 1 mashed banana, 1 egg, 1 cup milk, 1 tsp cinnamon, berries

1. Mix everything together.
2. Spoon into a muffin tin, bake 180°C / 350°F for 20 min.



SERVES 2 • 12 MIN • FIBRE

Cinnamon Poached Plums

You'll need: 4 plums (halved), 1 cinnamon stick, 1 cup water, 1 tsp honey

1. Simmer the plums with cinnamon, water and honey.
2. Cook 10 min until tender; serve warm.



SERVES 2 • 8 MIN • CALCIUM

Warm Berry Compote over Yogurt

You'll need: 1½ cups berries, a squeeze of lemon, yogurt to serve

1. Warm the berries with lemon until saucy, ~5 min.
2. Spoon over cold yogurt.



SERVES 4 • 40 MIN • CALCIUM • PROTEIN

Lighter Baked Custard

You'll need: 2 eggs, 2 cups milk, ½ tsp vanilla, 1 tbsp honey, nutmeg

1. Whisk and pour into ramekins; dust with nutmeg.
2. Bake in a water bath 160°C / 325°F for 35 min.



SERVES 3 • 15 MIN • FIBRE

Stewed Apple & Cinnamon

You'll need: 3 apples (chopped), ½ tsp cinnamon, a splash of water

1. Gently stew the apples with cinnamon and water.
2. Cook 12–15 min until soft — warm or cold.



No-Bake Bites & Bars

Little treats you make once and dip into all week. No oven, no fuss — just wholesome ingredients pressed together.

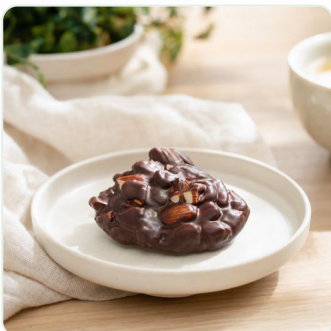


MAKES 12 • 15 MIN • FIBRE

Date & Oat Energy Bites

You'll need: 1 cup dates, 1 cup oats, 2 tbsp nut butter, 1 tbsp seeds

1. Blend the dates to a paste.
2. Mix with oats, nut butter and seeds; roll into balls and chill.



MAKES 12 • 20 MIN • ANTIOXIDANTS

Dark Chocolate Almond Clusters

You'll need: 100g dark chocolate (70%), 1 cup almonds

1. Melt the chocolate and stir in the almonds.
2. Spoon into clusters on paper; chill until set.



SERVES 4 • 1 HR • POTASSIUM

Peanut Butter Banana Bites

You'll need: 2 bananas (sliced), peanut butter, a little dark chocolate

1. Sandwich peanut butter between banana slices.
2. Drizzle with chocolate and freeze 1 hr.



MAKES 8 • 2 HR • FIBRE

No-Bake Oat & Berry Bars

You'll need: 2 cups oats, 1 cup dates, ½ cup dried berries, 3 tbsp nut butter

1. Blend, then press firmly into a lined tin.
2. Chill 2 hr and cut into bars.



SERVES 4 • 2 HR • CALCIUM

Yogurt-Dipped Frozen Grapes

You'll need: 2 cups grapes, 1 cup Greek yogurt

1. Dip the grapes in yogurt and lay on a tray.
2. Freeze until firm — a cooling little bite.



Lighter Baked Classics

The comfort of home baking, gently lightened — more oats and fruit, less sugar and refined flour.



MAKES 12 • 20 MIN • NO ADDED SUGAR

3-Ingredient Oat & Banana Cookies

You'll need: 2 ripe bananas, 1½ cups oats, a handful of raisins

1. Mash the bananas; mix with oats and raisins.
2. Spoon onto a tray, bake 180°C / 350°F for 15 min.



MAKES 12 • 30 MIN • FIBRE

Whole-Grain Apple Muffins

You'll need: 2 cups whole-grain flour, 1 grated apple, 1 egg, 1 cup milk, 2 tbsp honey, 1 tsp cinnamon

1. Mix wet and dry separately, then combine.
2. Spoon into a tin, bake 180°C / 350°F for 20 min.



MAKES 12 • 30 MIN • FIBRE

Carrot & Walnut Muffins

You'll need: 1 cup grated carrot, 2 cups whole-grain flour, 1 egg, 1 cup milk, 1 tsp cinnamon, walnuts

1. Combine into a batter.
2. Spoon into a tin, bake 180°C / 350°F for 20 min.



SERVES 4 • 30 MIN • FIBRE

Almond & Berry Crumble

You'll need: 3 cups berries, 1 cup oats, ¼ cup ground almonds, 2 tbsp butter, 1 tbsp honey

1. Rub oats, almonds and butter into a crumble; scatter over berries.
2. Bake 180°C / 350°F for 25 min.



MAKES 9 • 30 MIN • HEALTHY FATS

Dark Chocolate Avocado Brownies

You'll need: 1 avocado, ½ cup cocoa, 2 eggs, ⅓ cup honey, ½ cup oat flour

1. Blend the avocado with eggs and honey.
2. Fold in cocoa and oat flour; bake 180°C / 350°F for 20 min.

Smart sweet swaps

A few easy switches that keep the pleasure and lose some of the sugar.

Sugar → mashed ripe banana, dates, or a little honey. **Cream** → Greek yogurt or whipped ricotta. **White flour** → oats or whole-grain flour. **Chocolate** → a little dark chocolate (70%+). **Ice cream** → blended frozen banana “nice cream”.

When to check with your doctor. Please speak with a healthcare professional about sweet foods and portions if you have diabetes or prediabetes, kidney disease, difficulty swallowing, or dietary restrictions, or if you take medication affected by certain foods (such as grapefruit or high-potassium ingredients).

This guide is part of the Tai Motion Tai Chi Guide Series. It offers general wellness suggestions only and is not medical or dietary advice. It is not intended to diagnose, treat, cure, or prevent any condition. Always talk to a qualified healthcare professional before changing your diet, especially if you have a health condition or take medication. © Tai Motion.